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Case Study

No-Strings-Attached Hospitality

Hotel Golconda in Hyderabad has deployed wireless LAN across five floors. Find out why Wi-Fi is the new buzzword in the hospitality industry

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With information technology changing the face of corporate India, it was only a matter of time before this had an impact on other businesses. Cities in IT hubs of the country are facing a new challenge—catering to the tech savvy clients. Even hotels are not spared of the ever-changing needs of this fraternity. Perhaps, they could take a leaf out of Hotel Golconda's book and create a haven for the tech-enabled traveller.

"Thanks to IT, the face of Hyderabad has changed in the past decade. Today, the hospitality industry in particular, is catering to a new segment—IT and Biotech professionals—who demand certain services and use those facilities actively," says Suresh Reddy, executive director, Hotel Golconda.

Located in the heart of Hyderabad, Hotel Golconda, which falls into the three-star category, recently installed a Wireless LAN on their premises. This wireless "hotspot" has been

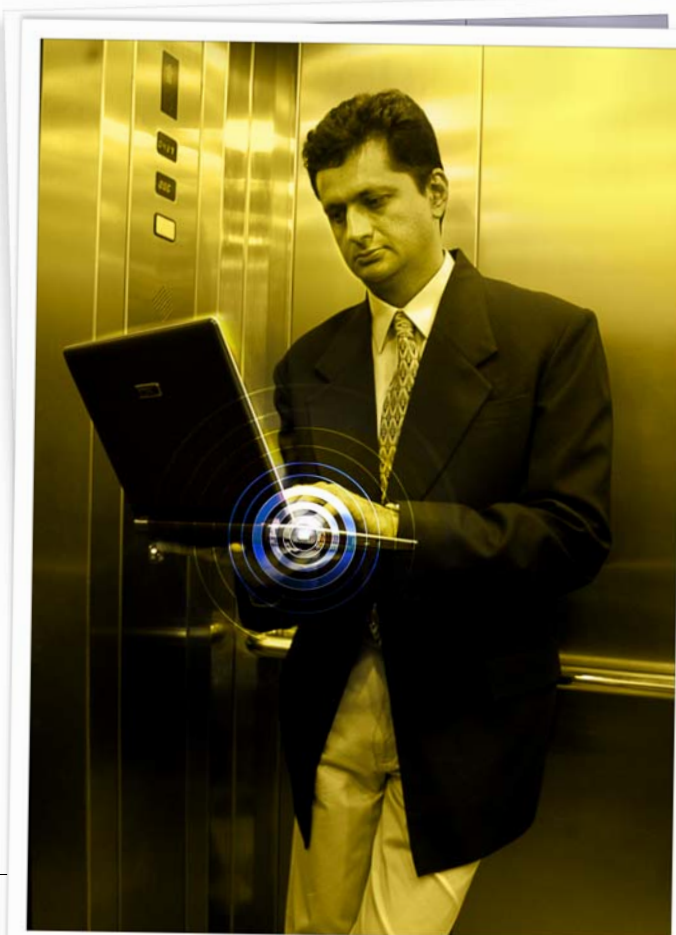
deployed across five floors (and two more would be networked soon with six additional access points). Guests can now access the Internet from anywhere in the hotel at an additional charge of Rs 200 per day.

Internet access being a prerequisite for almost all business travellers, Wi-Fi enabled hotels have become more the norm than the exception. In India, deployment of Wireless LANs has largely been restricted to four- and five-star hotels (about 200 such hotels in India are Wi-Fi enabled).

Wi-Fi Central

Golconda, which derives its name from the majestic fort located on the outskirts of Hyderabad, is nearly 15-years-old, and has a capacity of 150 rooms. Says Reddy: "The hotel was inaugurated in August 1989 and has been renovated since. About a year-and-half ago, we were one of the first hotels in Hyderabad to offer Wi-Fi connectivity to our customers. The response has been excellent."

To set up the Wireless LAN, Cisco Aironet 1100-series Access Points were



Location Courtesy CenterOne, Vashi
Photographs Jiten Gandhi
Imaging Binesh Sreedharan